That is quite a bold claim to make but it has increasingly now been echoed by others. As for the British government, the choice was no less clear in whether Bhagat Singh should live or die because '[f]or the colonial authorities, the survival of Bhagat Singh could have meant facing a revolutionary movement against them in competition with the ever compromising Gandhi-led Congress movement'. Professor Pritam Singh has been uncompromising in his denunciation, as has Justice Markandey Katju of late, that '[t]he Indian National Congress and the Indian State know and understand that Gandhi and the Congress party were deeply implicated in the colonial hanging of Bhagat Singh', and that is the reason, according to Pritam Singh, why it is the case that 'while 1857 and 1947 anniversaries continue to be commemorated, the 100th birth anniversary of Bhagat Singh will remain an embarrassing and, therefore, a marginal affair for the Congress-led Indian government'. After all, '[t]he political economy of the current Indian nation state necessitates this stance'.[12] In short, as Pritam Singh has more recently argued, whereas the 'Gandhian path was focused only on the transfer of political power', 'Bhagat Singh's vision was to transform independent India into a socialist and an egalitarian society'. And herein lay the problem.[13]

Criticism of Gandhi from other sources also abounds. In what he describes as his 'most sensitive chapter of the volume', M.M. Juneja in his *Biography of Bhagat Singh* also examines 'Gandhi's attitude'[14] to the release of Bhagat Singh. Juneja's focus is on the week after the rejection by the Privy Council of Bhagat Singh's petition against the penalty of death by hanging. This is when on 17 February 1931 there were negotiations between Viceroy Lord Irwin and Mahatma Gandhi over the release of political prisoners who had taken part in Gandhi's non-cooperation movement. Gandhi found time on the afternoon of 18 February 1931 to raise the question of Bhagat Singh, who was not one of the political prisoners in Gandhi's movement. The viceroy made a detailed written note of what transpired between the two of them. What we learn of Gandhi is that '[h]e did not plead for commutation, although he would, being opposed to all taking of life, take that course himself'. However, what the viceroy